



is just out there; in the wireless Web, the operators themselves control the content that users can access.

As indicators of search companies venturing into the arena, Google has deals with Vodafone and T-Mobile; Yahoo! has a deal with Orange, and recently announced that its mobile search engine will be embedded in some new Nokia handsets.

There's another issue for carriers: whether to go with branded search, or to build their own search tools. Going with, for example, Google, means risking losing control of the ad revenue that comes from the search application. Also at risk is the dilution of their brand. Some mobile operators in the US have therefore opted to build their own search tools, with the help of less-well-known companies in search.

"The more things people are able to do with their mobile phones, the more indispensable they will become," says Iain

Gillott, an analyst with iGillott Research. "Today people select a service provider based on coverage, price and customer service. But once those things are all equal, search could become a differentiator."

THE WORLD-DOMINATION DEPT.

New Google Offerings

Google has opened up its "news archive" search, at <http://news.google.com/archivesearch>, with items reaching back to the beginning of the 19th century. It is limited as of now—there are just a few publications, such as *Time* magazine and *Guardian* newspaper, that give their news content from earlier generations for free. But then there are publications such as *The New York Times* and the *Wall Street Journal* that also appear in the search results, for which you have

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